<table>
<tr><th>Subspecies (race)</th><th>Resistant to disease and parasites</th><th>Spring build-up</th><th>Gentle</th><th>Low tendency to swarm</th><th>Honey production</th><th>Overwintering ability</th><th>Low tendency to rob</th></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="2">Italian
Apis mellifera ligustica</td><td>No</td><td>Yes</td><td>Yes</td><td>Yes</td><td>Yes</td><td>Good</td><td>No</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="7">This is the most common subspecies in the US. They were introduced in the 1860s, from Italy, although now the subspecies has mixed genetics, from natural and artificial mating with other subspecies. Italians tend to be less defensive and they were originally seen as being less prone to disease than other subspecies - but times have changed and their tendency to drift encourages the spread of pests and disease. Although they are excellent honey producers, they consume much of the surplus because of their prolonged brood rearing and are notorious robbers. They construct new comb quickly. They have yellow and black abdomens.</td></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="2">Carniolan
Apis mellifera carnica</td><td>No</td><td>Yes, fast</td><td>Yes</td><td>No</td><td>Yes</td><td>Good</td><td>No</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="7">Carniolans are known for their tendency to overwinter well. The subspecies is originally from eastern Europe. They are docile bees and colonies grow rapidly in the spring, making them available to pollinate the earliest blooms. Because of this, however, they are prone to swarming. They are less likely to rob out other colonies than other subspecies, but are slow to construct new comb.</td></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="2">Caucasian
Apis mellifera caucasica</td><td>No</td><td>No, slow</td><td>Yes</td><td>Yes</td><td>No</td><td>Poor</td><td>Yes</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="7">This is a less common subspecies, introduced into the United States in 1882 from eastern Europe. The bees are gentle and can pollinate a wide range of crops because of their long tongue. They create a lot of propolis - helpful for disease protection, but often quite sticky for beekeepers. They have a dark abdomen.</td></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="2">Buckfast</td><td>Yes</td><td>No, slow</td><td>Moderate</td><td>Yes</td><td>Yes</td><td>Good</td><td>No</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="7">In the 1920s, Brother Adam, a monk in England’s Buckfast Abbey, set off on a trip around the British Isles searching for a strain of honey bee resistant to the tracheal mite, Acarapis woodi, but also gentle, productive, and easy to keep healthy. From a mix of subspecies and hybrids, he created a stock known as Buckfast bees. Buckfast bees express hygienic behavior and are moderately defensive. They have yellow and black on their abdomens. They are not widely available.</td></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="2">German
Apis mellifera mellifera</td><td>No</td><td>Yes</td><td>No</td><td>No</td><td>Yes</td><td>Good</td><td>No</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="7">Also known as the European dark bee, A. m. mellifera was brought to the United States in 17th century by European settlers. They overwinter well in cold climates and have a low tendency to swarm, but are more defensive and susceptible to American and European foulbrood. They are no longer common in the US. They have black abdomens.</td></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="2">Russian</td><td>Yes</td><td>Yes</td><td>Moderate</td><td>No</td><td>Yes</td><td>Good</td><td>No</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="7">Russian bees are a Caucasian, Italian, or Carniolan hybrid. They were introduced to Louisiana from far eastern Russia for because of their relative resistance to Varroa and tracheal mites. Unfortunately, they can sometimes be quite defensive and tend to swarm. They readily shut down brood rearing in times of dearth. They have a dark abdomen.</td></tr>
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African, Africanized *Apis mellifera scutellata* x other	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	Poor	No
	Africanized honey bees are primarily recognizable by their aggression and are not easily managed. They rob other colonies and are prone to swarming. They demonstrate a relative resistance to *Varroa* mites. Their bodies are small, with black and yellow abdomens. They have a tendency to produce abundant propolis.						
Other stocks of bees currently available							
Ankle biter/ Mite biter	The new “Purdue ankle biter” was developed at Purdue University to help the honey bees defend against *Varroa* mites. They bite off the legs and body parts of the mites, a trait originating from their grooming behavior.						
VSH	In 2001, Varroa Sensitive Hygiene honey bees (VSH) were created in a USDA lab in Louisiana. These bees use hygienic behavior to combat mite infestations. The Minnesota Hygienic Line was developed at the University of Minnesota. A newer USDA version of this stock is called Pol-line. These Pol-line VSH bees are better suited for commercial, migratory operations who use their bees for crop pollination.						
Saskatraz	In 2006, the Saskatraz Breeding Program began in Saskatchewan, Canada. This program raises honey bees that are bred for honey production, wintering ability, increased *Varroa* tolerance, hygienic behavior, and increased resistance to brood diseases.						
Cordovan	Cordovan bees were bred for recognizable color differences. Cordovans are not a subspecies, but are bees of a specific color. The queens have light gold abdomen tips that allow them to be easily spotted by the beekeeper, and the workers are also lighter, having brown banding instead of black. Cordovan bees carry specific versions of a gene that causes this light body color. Beekeepers can select for bees that carry this gene from many different stocks of bees that are available to them.						
Historical bee stocks							
Midnight™ *no longer available*	This hybrid bee stock was created to combine the most desirable traits from Caucasian and Carniolan stocks in the United States. They are no longer available, but were known for their gentleness, honey production, and high production of propolis. They had a dark abdomen.						
Starline™ *no longer available*	This hybrid bee stock was created under the same project as the Midnight™ stock by breeding two Italian stocks together. They are no longer available, but were known to be productive foragers and good clover pollinators, and often need requeening and/or superseded their existing queens. The bees had yellow and black on their abdomens.						